

CAOCAP UX Research & Onboarding Audit

PRODUCT EXPERIENCE REVIEW & STRATEGIC RECOMMENDATIONS

PREPARED BY	FOCUS AREA	KEY OBJECTIVE
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Executive Summary

After a comprehensive review of the onboarding journey and initial product experience, the primary driver of drop-off is **not visual design**. CAOCAP possesses a highly innovative core concept: *Learn web development by chatting with AI while building interactive apps and games inside a spatial canvas*.

Unfortunately, this value proposition is never clearly communicated during the first experience. Users aren't abandoning the app due to aesthetics; they leave because they experience extreme cognitive load and lack mental clarity around: **What CAOCAP actually is, what they are expected to do, why the spatial canvas exists, and what success looks like**.

The current onboarding prioritizes narrative theme (space) over functional utility, creating immediate friction after installation.

Overall UX Audit & Priority Assessment

PRIORITY	IDENTIFIED FRICTION POINT	IMPACT LEVEL	CORE DRIVER
CRITICAL	Product Value Unclear	Very High	Emotional copy replaces functional explanation.
CRITICAL	Canvas Undiscoverable	Very High	No interaction cues for drag/zoom spatial UI.
CRITICAL	Passive Tutorial System	Very High	Static tooltip cards get instantly skipped.
CRITICAL	AI Purpose Unclear	Very High	Generic greeting leads to user hesitation.
HIGH	Companion Selection Lacks Context	High	Avatars lack explicit capability descriptions.
HIGH	Coding Level Lacks Feedback	High	Slider doesn't explain what changes per level.
HIGH	No Immediate "First Win"	High	Zero achievement or dopamine moment in 60s.
MEDIUM	Premature Paywall	Medium	Subscription requested before value is proven.
MEDIUM	Disconnected Gamification	Medium	XP/Badges lack clear context during onboarding.

Detailed UX Audit & Key Recommendations

1. Value Proposition is Missing (Core Onboarding)

CRITICAL

Current onboarding uses emotional/thematic copy ("Countdown to launch", "One small step", "The view changes everything"). While motivational, it fails to inform users what the app actually does.

CURRENT MENTAL MODEL

"Looks beautiful... but what is this app and why should I stay?"

DESIRED MENTAL MODEL

"Oh, I build interactive games with AI co-pilots. This is awesome."

ACTIONABLE RECOMMENDATION

Replace abstract copy with benefit-driven screens: **Screen 1:** "Build interactive games with AI." • **Screen 2:** "Learn HTML, CSS & JS with real projects." • **Screen 3:** "Your AI co-pilot explains every line of code."

2. Canvas Interface Discovery Failure

CRITICAL

The spatial canvas suffers from a critical discoverability gap. During testing and user onboarding, users consistently mistake the interactive canvas for a static dashboard, roadmap, or decorative illustration. Because there are no visual signifiers for affordances (dragging, zooming, or tapping nodes), users fail to interact with the core spatial workspace on their own.

ACTIONABLE RECOMMENDATION

Implement a 3-second **Auto-Camera Tour** upon canvas entry. Auto-pan left/right, zoom out slightly, highlight active nodes, and display an animated hand gesture demonstrating panning and pinching. Show, don't tell.

3. Passive Tutorials & Empty AI Experience

CRITICAL

Text tooltips are ignored. Additionally, after saying "Hi", the AI leaves users stranded without next steps.

ACTIONABLE RECOMMENDATION

Replace text popups with **interactive action loops**. The AI should immediately suggest prompt options:

 Build Pac-Man ,  Build Notes App , or  Build Weather App . One tap delivers instant execution.

4. Contextless Personalization (Companions & Skill Level)

HIGH

Users select companions and skill levels without knowing how it impacts their experience, making decisions feel arbitrary.

ACTIONABLE RECOMMENDATION

Add brief role descriptions: **CoCaptain** (Practical coding mentor, beginner-focused) vs. **CoStar** (Creative brainstorming partner). Dynamic labels on skill slider: *Beginner (Guided coding + Small lessons)* vs. *Advanced (Minimal hints + Pro workflow)*.

5. Absence of a "First Success Moment" & Early Paywall

HIGH

Onboarding ends without achievement. Furthermore, paywalls appear before users feel value, triggering premature churn.

ACTIONABLE RECOMMENDATION

Deliver a **60-Second Win**: User taps prompt → AI builds Tic-Tac-Toe → User plays immediately → Confetti celebration. Delay paywall trigger until *after* this first completed project.

Proposed Optimized Onboarding Journey

A restructured sequence focused on immediate value delivery, interactive guidance, and progressive disclosure:

01. **Splash & Value Prop:** Clear statement — "Build real web apps with AI co-pilots."

02. **Visual Proof:** Showcase project cards (Pac-Man, Games, Dashboard templates).

03. **Contextual Personalization:** Select AI Mentor (with role clarity) & Coding Level (with dynamic feedback).

04. **Launch Transition:** Expectation screen ("Preparing workspace... Next: Build your first game").

05. **Auto Spatial Tour:** Canvas animates drag/zoom with gesture hints (Solves discoverability).

06. **Interactive AI First Win:** AI prompts "Build Pac-Man" → Tap → Generates Code → Play & Celebrate.

07. **Gamification & Progression:** Award +50 XP / Level 2 badge to cement retention.

08. **Open Exploration & Soft Paywall:** Free canvas exploration; introduce paywall only on extra build requests.

Final Strategic Assessment

CAOCAP has a genuinely innovative concept combining AI coding, spatial navigation, and project-based learning. The visual design is polished; the primary barrier is **onboarding self-sufficiency**. Aligning onboarding with immediate user action rather than passive explanation will significantly increase activation rates, project completion, and long-term retention.